General Umrao Singh; Brigadier Mukul Pant, son of Major B. K. Pant; Labella Kathing Gupta and Professor Labrang Khathing, the children of Major Bob Khathing; Colonel N. J. S. Pannu, the son of Lieutenant Colonel Gurdial Singh; Narender Rathore, the younger brother of Lieutenant Bikram Singh; and many others who generously gave me their time. My grateful thanks also to Claude Arpi, the son-in-law of Major General (at the time Lieutenant Colonel) K. K. Tewari, who put me in touch with some of the other families.

My thanks to Wing Commander B. S. Rathee for having made available the photographs of Brigadier Hoshiar Singh's funeral at Phudung and also Karan Thapar for having given me the photograph of his father, General Pran Thapar. My grateful thanks also to Air Marshal Bharat Kumar, Colonel Amandeep Singh Herr of 20 Lancers, Colonel Balbir Singh of 2 Rajput, Colonel Ankush Thakur of 13 Mechanised Infantry (18 Rajput) and various others who helped source photographs. Colonel Hunny Bakshi shared his photographs of the Nam Ka Chu, having gone into the valley as a young lieutenant some twenty-seven years after the conflict. He had then returned with a fistful of dog tags recovered from the skeletal remains they unearthed from the various bunkers and trenches. Most of the tags had serial numbers beginning with the numerals '29' denoting 2 Rajput.

It was a happy coincidence that my classmate from school, Dr Atul Bahadur Singh, who lives and practises medicine in Najibabad, should be the nephew of Major Sitaram Johri, who painstakingly documented the fighting in both the NEFA and Ladakh theatres during the face-off with the Chinese. Major Johri had served in NEFA as a political officer, but he made three special trips to Ladakh visiting Dungti, Tsaka-la, Chushul, Phobrang, Tangtse, Darbuk and the Shyok village, meeting and interviewing people. It was ironic that he failed to find a publisher and had to eventually self-publish the books that have been extensively quoted, even in the official history of the 1962 operations. I am most grateful to his family for having made available to me his research papers and notes.

There are many officers who are no more with us today, but whose contribution to the book has been immense. Lieutenant General S. K. Pillai, with whom I discussed the various chapters ad nauseam, was a constant source of encouragement. And finally, my father, who generously handed over all the research notes that he had painstakingly put together for his book, *Rivers of Silence*, which first documented 2 Rajput's battle in Nam